catalog metadata and allowing it to be used in a self-serve manner.

- *Containing at least one domain data set*—The product must have a dataset that itself has business value. Movie Popularity contains a dataset of movie rankings from a given week, Scripts contains a dataset of metadata about scripts, and Cost Statement contains a dataset of movie production costs.
- *Satisfying user needs*—The data product was created with product thinking in mind, and it has clearly defined users. In the case of Cost Statement, these are accountants who financially control production costs.

5.2.2 Product, not project

As you already know, the use of the term *product* in a data mesh is not accidental. It is worth contrasting it with the term *project*, commonly used to name various kinds of initiatives carried out in organizations. It is worth emphasizing that the creation of a data product should not be treated as a project. A project is a time-limited activity that is supposed to lead to a specific goal. The project ends and may not be continued.

On the other hand, product thinking makes us look at a data product from a long-term perspective that goes beyond just making it available. This approach also assumes it has further development, adjusting it based on the feedback gathered from users. Product thinking includes the idea of continuous improvement and long-term thinking about quality, as opposed to a one-time project.

5.2.3 What can be a data product?

What could be a candidate for a data product? In general, any data representation that has value for users can be a good candidate. The following are examples:

- *Raw unstructured files*—For example, images generated by geological sampling equipment or videos uploaded by users of a video portal. However, to be useful to end users, these files should be accompanied by sufficient metadata that describes them.